

Object Oriented Analysis and Design

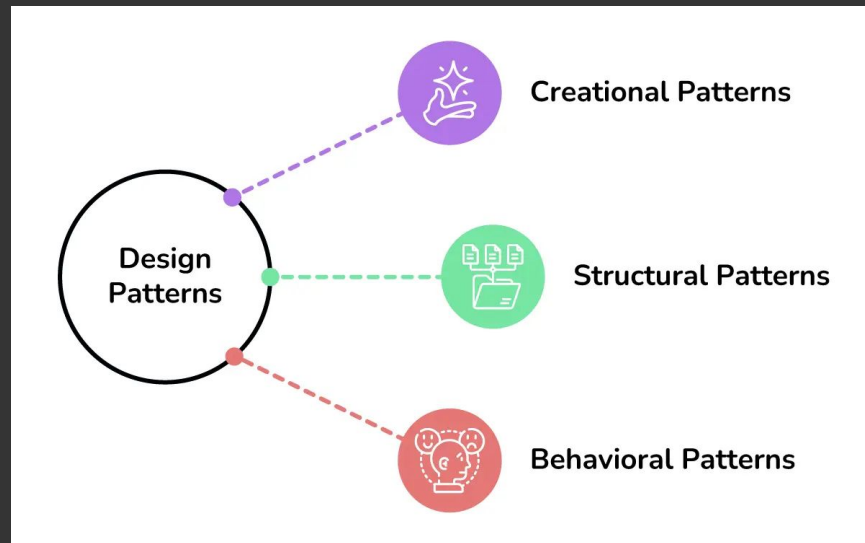
Design Patterns:
Template Method , Strategy,
Iterator

Vladimir Soroka



3 Categories Of Patterns

- **Creational** – object creation
- **Structural** – class/object composition
- **Behavioral** – object interaction & responsibility



What are we covering?

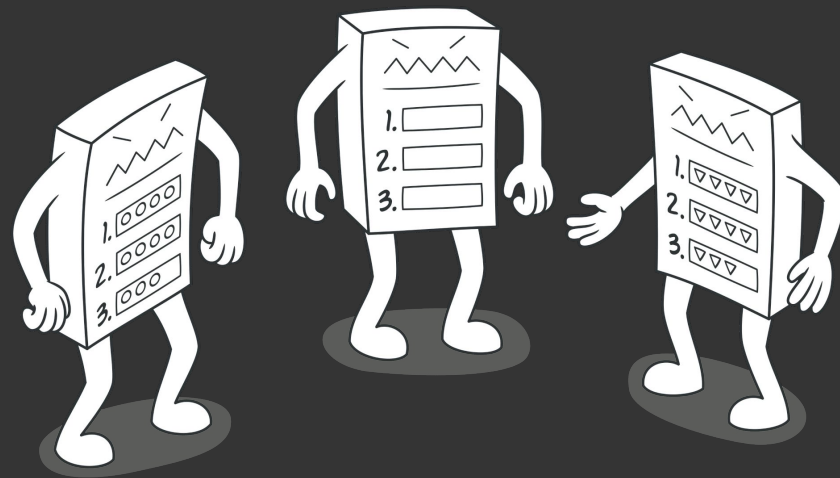
- **Template Method** – behavioral
- **Strategy** - behavioral
- **Iterator** - behavioral



The Template Method Pattern

- Purpose

- Defines the **skeleton of an algorithm** in a method, deferring some steps to subclasses.
- Lets subclasses **redefine specific steps** without changing the algorithm structure.
- Promotes **code reuse** and **behavior consistency** across similar classes.



 **Analogy:** “Think of a recipe template – the steps are fixed, but the ingredients can vary.”

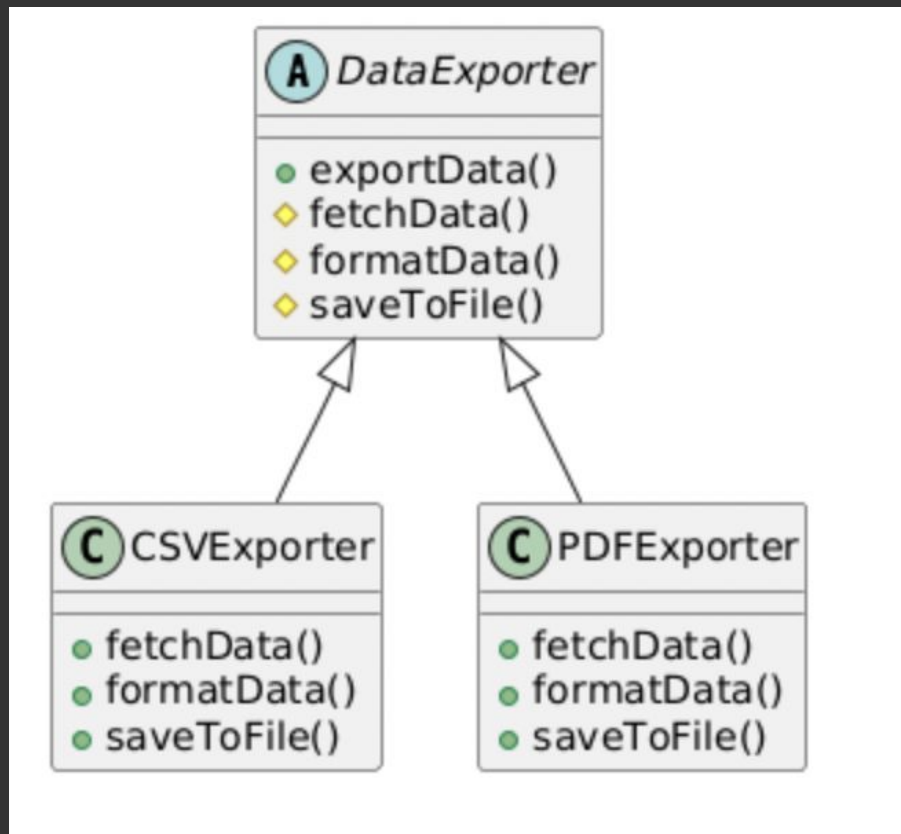
Template Method UML

```
@startuml
abstract class DataExporter {
    + exportData()
    # fetchData()
    # formatData()
    # saveToFile()
}

class CSVExporter {
    + fetchData()
    + formatData()
    + saveToFile()
}

class PDFExporter {
    + fetchData()
    + formatData()
    + saveToFile()
}

DataExporter <|-- CSVExporter
DataExporter <|-- PDFExporter
@enduml
```



Template Method - Example



```
class DataExporter {  
public:  
    void exportData() {  
        fetchData();  
        formatData();  
        saveToFile();  
    }  
  
protected:  
    virtual void fetchData() = 0;  
    virtual void formatData() = 0;  
    virtual void saveToFile() {  
        std::cout << "Saving to default path..." << std::endl;  
    }  
};
```

Template Method - Example

```
class CSVExporter : public DataExporter {
protected:
    void fetchData() override {
        std::cout << "Fetching data for CSV..." << std::endl;
    }
    void formatData() override {
        std::cout << "Formatting data as CSV." << std::endl;
    }
};

class PDFExporter : public DataExporter {
protected:
    void fetchData() override {
        std::cout << "Fetching data for PDF..." << std::endl;
    }
    void formatData() override {
        std::cout << "Formatting data as PDF." << std::endl;
    }
    void saveToFile() override {
        std::cout << "Saving PDF to secure folder." << std::endl;
    }
};
```

When to Use Template Method?

- You have multiple operations that follow **identical structure**, with varying steps.
- You want to **prevent duplicate logic** in subclasses.
- You want to **enforce an execution order**.



What's Bad About Template Method?

- **Inheritance Lock-In** – Can't change behavior without subclassing.
- **Class Explosion** – Every variation requires a new subclass.
- **Hidden Flow** – Template method logic split between base and subclass.
- **Harder Testing** – Need to instantiate hierarchy just to test flow.



Template Method Summary

- Template Method lets you fix **workflow structure** while customizing parts.
- Keeps shared logic in the base class, variation in subclasses.
- Use when structure must remain **stable**, but steps can change.
- Be cautious of **rigid hierarchies** and consider alternatives like **Strategy**.

The Strategy Pattern

Purpose

- Encapsulates **interchangeable algorithms** or behaviors.
- Allows selecting an algorithm **at runtime**.
- Promotes **open/closed principle**: new strategies without modifying existing code.

 **Analogy:** “Like choosing between driving, biking, or walking to work – same goal, different strategies.”



Strategy UML

@startuml

```
interface PaymentStrategy {  
    + pay(amount: float)  
}
```

```
class CreditCardPayment {  
    + pay(amount: float)  
}
```

```
class PayPalPayment {  
    + pay(amount: float)  
}
```

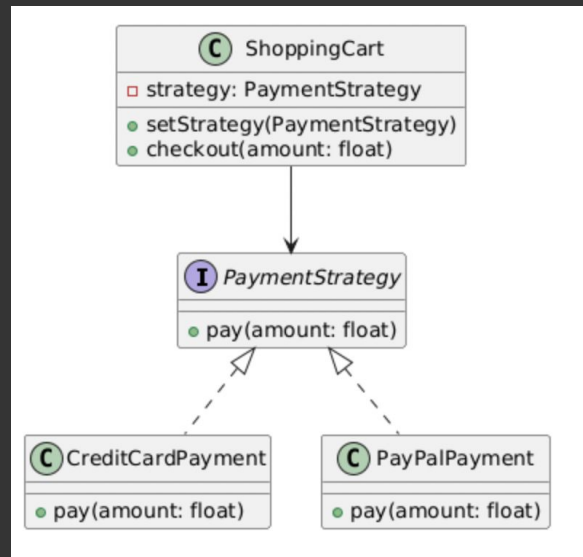
```
class ShoppingCart {  
    - strategy: PaymentStrategy  
    + setStrategy(PaymentStrategy)  
    + checkout(amount: float)  
}
```

```
PaymentStrategy <|..  
    CreditCardPayment
```

```
PaymentStrategy <|..  
    PayPalPayment
```

```
ShoppingCart --> PaymentStrategy
```

@enduml



Strategy Code - Example

```
class PaymentStrategy {
public:
    virtual void pay(float amount) = 0;
    virtual ~PaymentStrategy() = default;
};

class ShoppingCart {
    PaymentStrategy* strategy;
public:
    void setStrategy(PaymentStrategy* s) {
        strategy = s;
    }

    void checkout(float amount) {
        if (strategy)
            strategy->pay(amount);
        else
            std::cerr << "No payment strategy selected.\n";
    }
};
```

Strategy Code - Example

```
class CreditCard : public PaymentStrategy {
public:
    void pay(float amount) override {
        std::cout << "Paid $" << amount << " using credit card.\n";
    }
};

class PayPal : public PaymentStrategy {
public:
    void pay(float amount) override {
        std::cout << "Paid $" << amount << " using PayPal.\n";
    }
};
```

Strategy Code - Example

```
int main() {  
    ShoppingCart cart;  
  
    CreditCard card;  
    cart.setStrategy(&card);  
    cart.checkout(100.0);  
  
    PayPal paypal;  
    cart.setStrategy(&paypal);  
    cart.checkout(200.0);  
}
```

Paid \$100 using credit card.

Paid \$200 using PayPal.

When to Use Strategy?

- You have many **variations** of the same **algorithm**.
- You want to **select behavior** at runtime.
- You want to **eliminate long conditionals** (e.g., if...else or switch-case).
- You want to follow **composition over inheritance**.



What's Bad About Strategy?

1. Strategy Selection is Manual

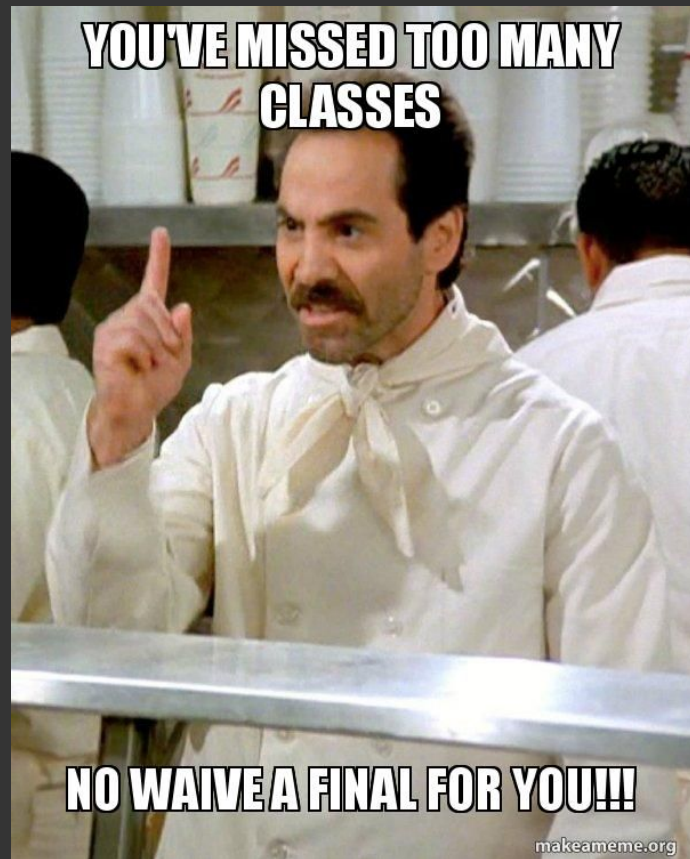
```
if (userChoosesCard)
    cart.setStrategy(&card); // Client
must know strategies
```

🧠 Requires external logic or UI input to pick a strategy.

2. Too Many Classes

SortAscending, SortDescending,
SortRandomized, ...

😱 Explodes in complexity if each variation is implemented separately.



What's Bad About Strategy?

3. Strategies May Need Context Info

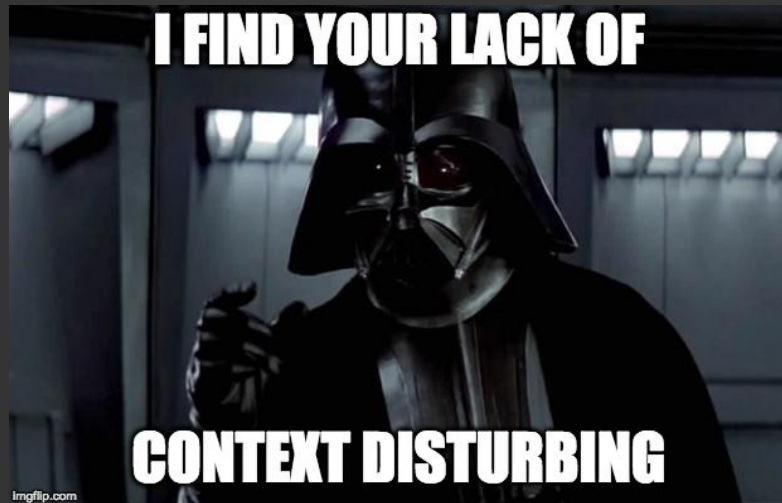
```
// Strategy can't access customer profile  
unless passed manually
```

```
strategy->pay(user.amount); // limited  
context
```

💔 Breaks encapsulation if not designed well.

4. Performance Overhead (if misused)

- Too much indirection in performance-critical paths.
- Simple strategy could be inlined.



Strategy - Summary

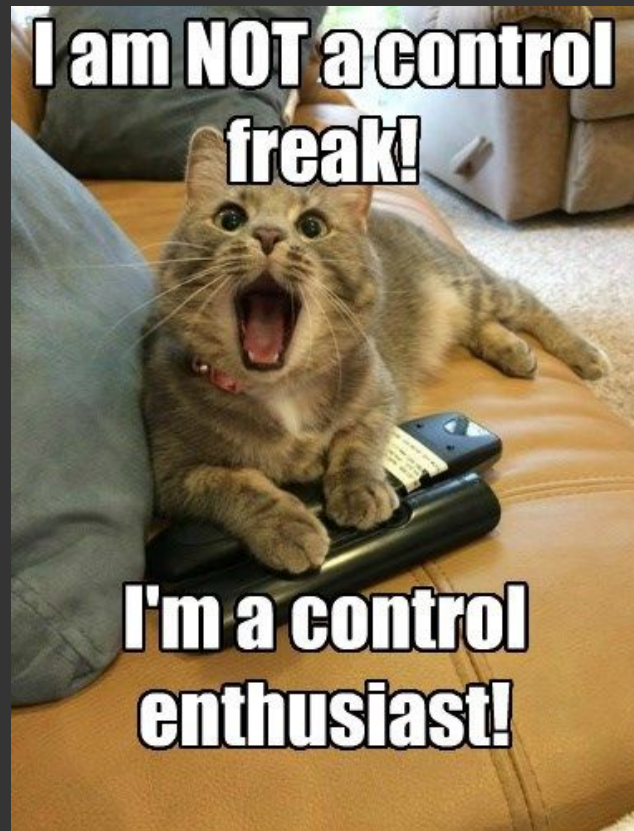
- Strategy lets you **encapsulate algorithms** and swap them at runtime.
- Promotes clean code and avoids giant conditional blocks.
- Ideal for **UI behaviors, AI logic, business rules**.
- Use with care: balance flexibility vs complexity.

The Iterator Pattern

Purpose

- Provides a **standard way to access elements** of a collection sequentially.
- Allows traversal without exposing the collection's **internal structure**.
- Enables **multiple concurrent traversals**.

 **Analogy:** “Like using a remote control to browse TV channels without opening the TV casing.”



Iterator UML

```
@startuml
```

```
interface Iterator {  
    + hasNext(): bool  
    + next(): string  
}
```

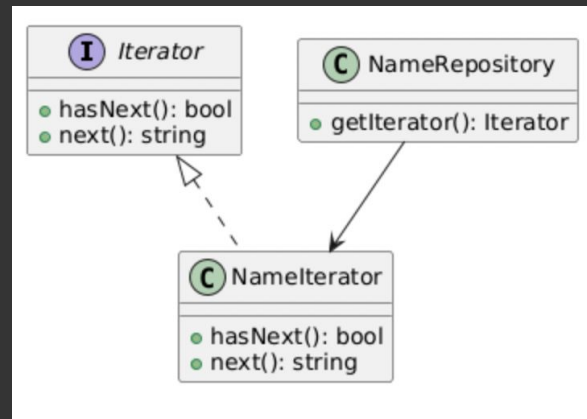
```
class NameIterator {  
    + hasNext(): bool  
    + next(): string  
}
```

```
class NameRepository {  
    + getIterator(): Iterator  
}
```

```
Iterator <|.. NameIterator
```

```
NameRepository --> NameIterator
```

```
@enduml
```



Iterator Code - Example



```
template<typename T>
class Iterator {
public:
    virtual bool hasNext() = 0;
    virtual T next() = 0;
    virtual ~Iterator() = default;
};

class NameRepository {
    std::vector<std::string> names;
public:
    NameRepository() : names{"Alice", "Bob", "Charlie"} {}

    class NameIterator : public Iterator<std::string> {
        const std::vector<std::string>& names;
        size_t index = 0;
    public:
        NameIterator(const std::vector<std::string>& n) : names(n) {}
        bool hasNext() override { return index < names.size(); }
        std::string next() override { return names[index++]; }
    };

    std::unique_ptr<Iterator<std::string>> getIterator() {
        return std::make_unique<NameIterator>(names);
    }
};
```

Strategy Code - Example

```
int main() {  
    NameRepository repo;  
    auto it = repo.getIterator();  
  
    while (it->hasNext()) {  
        std::cout << it->next() << std::endl;  
    }  
}
```

When to Use Iterator?

- You want to **hide the internal structure** of a collection.
- You need to **traverse complex data** (trees, graphs) in a consistent way.
- You want to **support multiple simultaneous traversals** (e.g., cursors).
- You want a **uniform interface** for different types of collections.



What's Bad About Iterator?

1. Extra Indirection

```
std::vector<int>::iterator it =  
vec.begin(); // More verbose than  
range-for
```



Adds boilerplate over native language features in modern C++.

2. External Iterators Require Manual Management

```
while (it->hasNext()) { ... } //  
You must control the loop manually
```



Easy to misuse or forget termination conditions.



We can solve any problem by
introducing an extra level of
indirection.

— Butler Lampson —

AZ QUOTES

What's Bad About Iterator?

3. Can Expose Internal State (Poor Encapsulation)

If your iterator **returns pointers** or exposes internal nodes:

- `Node* next();` // Allows modification of internal state

⚠ Breaks encapsulation and leads to tight coupling.

4. Can Be Hard to Optimize

- For large or concurrent structures, simple iterators are **not efficient**.
- May not support **parallel access**, filtering, or lazy evaluation.



Iterator - Summary

- Iterator abstracts collection traversal.
- Decouples data structure from traversal logic.
- Ideal for **tree, graph, or composite** data structures.
- External iterators are flexible but require care.
- Modern C++ offers alternatives: **range-for, ranges, STL iterators**.

Bad Examples



Example 1

```
class Exporter {
public:
    void exportData() {
        open();
        write();
        close();
    }
    virtual void open() = 0;
    virtual void write() = 0;
    virtual void close() = 0;
};

class CSVExporter : public Exporter {
    void open() override { ... }
    void write() override { ... }
    void close() override { ... }
};
```

Example 2

```
class Base {
public:
    virtual void algorithm() {
        step1();
        step2();
    }
    virtual void step1() {}
    virtual void step2() {}
};

class Sub : public Base {
public:
    void algorithm() override { std::cout << "I'll do it my way"; }
};
```

Example 3

```
void process() {  
    auth();  
    log();  
    validate();  
    transform();  
    compress();  
    store();  
    notify();  
    cleanup();  
    audit();  
}
```

Example 4

```
if (type == "PayPal")  
    cart.setStrategy(new PayPal());  
else if (type == "Card")  
    cart.setStrategy(new CreditCard());
```


Example 5

```
class FastSort : public SortStrategy {  
public:  
    void sort() {  
        logStart();  
        quickSort();  
        logEnd();  
    }  
};
```

```
class SlowSort : public SortStrategy {  
public:  
    void sort() {  
        logStart();  
        bubbleSort();  
        logEnd();  
    }  
};
```

Example 6

```
class Context {  
    SortStrategy* strategy = new QuickSort();  
};
```

Example 7

```
T* next() {  
    return &internalArray[index++];  
}
```

Example 8

```
while (true) {  
    std::cout << it->next();  
}
```

Example 9

```
class MyVectorIterator {  
    std::vector<int>& vec;  
    size_t pos = 0;  
  
public:  
    MyVectorIterator(std::vector<int>& v) : vec(v) {}  
  
    bool hasNext() {  
        return pos < vec.size();  
    }  
  
    int next() {  
        return vec[pos++];  
    }  
};
```



